

Rose

A rose in bloom is hard to beat. All over the world, it is the flower of love and beauty. Roses were grown in Ancient Egypt and Rome to make scented rose water. Today, a rose festival is held every year in Bulgaria, where roses are grown to make rose oil. It takes about 2,000 petals to produce just 1 g (0.04 oz) of oil, which is used to create perfume.

Wild roses have simple white or pink flowers, and many have long stems that climb up other plants. Their sharp, backwards-pointing thorns help them hook onto branches for support. Gardeners have created thousands of types of rose. These can be packed with petals and are grown for their bright colours and smell.

